Training 11/11: recover, play out, wing backs and three runners

WJL U15 Blues
3-5-2

Wednesday 11 November 2026. 60 minutes. Tim and Deano. Our 3-5-2: recover and play out, wing backs and three runners.

Running order (60 minutes)

0 to 8	Warm up: pass, follow, open up. Everyone.
8 to 16	Side on rondo 5v2. Everyone, two rondos if 14 or more.
16 to 31	Split 1. Tim: recover and play out (back three, Calum, two wing backs, two attackers). Deano: wing backs and three runners (keeper, two wing backs, strikers, 8s).
31	Halfway whistle: the four wing backs swap pitches.
31 to 46	Split 2. Same coaches, same practices, other pair of wing backs.
46 to 48	Drinks.
48 to 58	Unit v unit game, 7v7 with our one keeper. Adapt to numbers.
58 to 60	Cool down and three questions.

Groups and the wing back swap

- Tim (defence): five centre backs (three in the line, two as attackers, rotate every round), Calum, and two wing backs.
- Deano (attack): our keeper, two strikers, the 8s, and the other two wing backs. Two reds rotate from the strikers and 8s.
- Wing backs: Ryan and Harry start with Tim, the other two start with Deano. Each pair swaps left and right halfway through their spell. At 31 minutes all four swap pitches.

Numbers on the night

- Rondo: one rondo of 5v2 up to 11 players, two rondos from 12 (5v2 and 4v2).
- Defence (Tim): four centre backs means one attacker plus the coach; six means rotate two in and out.
- Attack (Deano): 4v1 plus keeper with 12 or fewer, 5v2 as drawn with 14, 6v3 with 16.
- Game: 6v6 with 12, add a yellow floater for 13 or 15, 7v7 with 14, 8v8 with 16, 5v5 with 10 or 11.
- Only one keeper: he stays on Deano's pitch and in the big goal for the game. No keeper at all: shrink the big goal to two cones three metres apart and finish below knee height.

Kit

Balls (one each plus spares), blue, red, orange and one yellow bib, flat cones and tall cones, 1 full size goal, 2 mini goals for Tim, 1 mini goal for Deano (3 mini goals in total, 2 again for the game), 1 mannequin, 2 poles.

On the diagrams: blue is us, red is the opposition, orange is the attack unit in bibs, green is the keeper, amber is the coach. Watch every part with voice over in the Touchline app: Training 11/11. Pick My role to see your own job.

0 to 8 min: Warm up: pass, follow, open up

Tim and Deano | 15m square, 4 cones | Groups of 8, two at each cone



SET UP

- 15 metre square, a cone on each corner, two players on each cone.
- Two balls per square once they have it.
- Six minutes passing, then two minutes of moves across the square.

COACHING POINTS

- Pass and follow your pass.
- Back foot to the ball, open up, play it on the side away from where it came.
- Talk: say the name of who you are passing to.

HARDER AND EASIER

- Harder: two touch, then one touch, or add the second ball.
- Easier: stop it, then pass.

HOW IT RUNS, STEP BY STEP

1. **The square.** Warm up. A fifteen metre square with a cone on each corner and two of you on every cone. Pass and follow your pass. Get the legs going and the touch sharp before the rondo.
2. **Pass and follow.** One passes along the bottom to three and follows his pass to the back of that queue. Three opens up, plays it up the side to five and follows. Pass, follow, next man steps up.
3. **Receive on the half turn.** Now the key bit. Back foot to the ball, body open, so one touch takes it round the corner and you are already facing the next pass. Seven takes it across his body and plays it down to two.
4. **Two minutes of moves.** Last two minutes, no ball. Go across the square to the far cone and back. High knees, side steps, open the hips, then two short sprints. Then straight into the rondo.

8 to 16 min: Side on rondo 5v2

Tim and Deano | 14m square | 5 v 2, two rondos if 14 or more



SET UP

- 14 metre square. Five blues round the outside, two reds in the middle.
- Two touches. Swap the reds every 60 seconds.
- A pass that splits the two reds is a point.

COACHING POINTS

- Open your body. Back foot to the ball.
- Look before it arrives. Two looks.
- Pass through the middle when it is on.

HARDER AND EASIER

- Harder: one touch for a split pass, or a 12 metre square.
- Easier: three touches, or one red.

HOW IT RUNS, STEP BY STEP

1. **The rondo.** Five round the outside, two reds in the middle, fourteen metre square. Two touches. Stand side on so you can see the whole square, not square on to the ball.
2. **Open and look.** Four plays to five. Five has looked before it arrives, takes it on the back foot and plays it on to eight. Look, open, play. The reds have to keep shifting.
3. **Split pass: a point.** Eight sees the gap between the two reds and plays it straight through to six. That's a split pass and that's a point. If the gap is there, play through it.
4. **Win it and swap.** Six goes for the pass up to ten but the red reads it and wins it. Straight swap: the red who won it goes out, the blue who lost it goes in the middle. No moaning, just swap and go.

16 to 46 min: Recover and play out (Tim)

Tim | Our half, goal to halfway | Back three, Calum and two wing backs v two attackers



SET UP

- Our half, full size goal, two mini goals either side of the centre circle as our strikers, a mannequin in the middle.
- Five centre backs: three in the line, two as attackers, rotate every round.
- Calum stays in the unit. Two of our four wing backs on at a time.
- Coach plays it in behind from halfway.

COACHING POINTS

- Ball side goes, middle covers, far side tucks, Calum screens.
- Nobody stands and watches when it goes in behind.
- Win it, touch away from pressure, play out wide or through Calum.
- Final pass into a mini goal, like a pass into a striker.

HARDER AND EASIER

- Harder: attackers live from the start, or a third attacker.
- Easier: attackers at half pace and no tackling.

HOW IT RUNS, STEP BY STEP

1. **The shape.** Here's our unit. Three centre backs, Calum just in front of them, and a wing back each side. We start pushed out towards halfway. The two mini goals are our strikers, so that's where the final pass goes. The mannequin is their man in the middle. Learn the picture first, then learn your own bit.
2. **Ball in behind.** Coach plays it in behind, down the left. The second it goes, we go. Nobody stands and watches. The two attackers chase it, at half pace for now. Notice everyone starts dropping together, as one unit.
3. **Recover as a unit.** Ball side centre back goes to the ball. The middle centre back covers behind him. The far centre back tucks in and keeps an eye on the far post. Calum drops in to screen the middle. The left wing back drops to be the way out, the right wing back tucks in. We finish goalside and compact. Ball side goes, middle covers, far side tucks, Calum screens.
4. **Pattern A: out wide.** Left centre back wins it, takes a touch away from pressure and plays it to the left wing back. The wing back drives past halfway with his head up. As the ball goes out, the right wing back breaks high. The final pass goes into a mini goal, like a pass into a striker.
5. **Pattern B: through the middle.** Same recovery, different way out. The ball goes across the back three to the far centre back. Calum shows between the lines, receives on the half turn, then it goes wide to the right wing back. He drives and plays into the other mini goal. The mannequin blocks the direct route, so we have to play around it.
6. **Attackers go live.** Now the attackers press for real. The ball goes down the right this time. Same jobs: ball side goes, middle covers, far side tucks, Calum screens. Win it, play out, and hit a mini goal for a point. If the attackers score in the big goal or win it back, the point is theirs.
7. **Rotate the lads.** Five centre backs, so three play in the line and two are the attackers. Rotate every round so everyone plays all three line roles and the attacker job. Calum stays in the unit. We have four wing backs and only two are on here at a time. Ryan and Harry start here and swap sides halfway through their spell. At the halfway whistle all four wing backs swap over: Ryan and Harry go to Deano for the attacking practice, and the other two come in here and do the same.

NUMBERS ON THE NIGHT

- Four centre backs: three in the line, one attacker plus the coach as the second.
- Six centre backs: rotate two in and out every round.
- Wing back swap: Ryan and Harry start here, swap sides halfway through their spell, then all four wing backs swap pitches at the halfway whistle.

16 to 46 min: Wing backs and three runners (Deano)

Deano | Penalty box to 45m out, full width of the box plus wings | 5 v 2 plus keeper: two wing backs, two strikers and an 8 v two reds



SET UP

- Big goal with our keeper. Mini goal 45 metres out for the reds to counter into.
- Blues: two wing backs, two strikers and an 8. Reds: two defenders.
- Coach serves into the 8 from the top. Ten seconds to score.

COACHING POINTS

- Wing backs high and wide. First look is down the line.
- Cross early and low into the corridor between keeper and defenders.
- Three runners every time: near post, far post, and the 8 late to the edge or the penalty spot.
- Far wing back attacks the back post.
- One striker shows, one spins.

HARDER AND EASIER

- Harder: third red, or seven seconds to score.
- Easier: reds at half pace, or the cross is unopposed.

HOW IT RUNS, STEP BY STEP

1. **The set up.** Deano's practice. Two wing backs high and wide, two strikers, and an 8 behind them. Two reds and our keeper defend the big goal. The coach serves into the 8 and we have ten seconds to score. If the reds win it, they counter into the mini goal at the top.
2. **Pattern A: wide and early.** Coach into the 8, and straight out to the left wing back. He drives down the line and crosses early and low. Three runners: one striker near post, one far post, and the 8 arrives late on the edge. The far wing back attacks the back post. Near post finish.
3. **Pattern B: one shows, one spins.** This time it goes through the middle. One striker shows short and drags his red with him. He sets it back to the 8. The other striker spins in behind into the gap, and the 8 slides it through. One shows, one spins. Finish across the keeper.
4. **Pattern C: switch to the free wing back.** If the reds shift across to the ball, the far wing back is free. Back to the 8, switch it, and the right wing back drives into the box. Strikers attack the posts, so he cuts it back to the 8 on the edge. Make them shift, then go the other way.
5. **Go live: ten seconds.** Now it is live. Blues get ten seconds from the coach's pass to score. Reds defend for real. Here the red wins it off the wing back and goes for the mini goal. The nearest two blues press straight away for five seconds. Rotate the reds every three minutes.
6. **Wing back swap and numbers.** We have four wing backs and two are on here at a time. The other two start with Tim on the defending practice. Swap sides left and right halfway through your spell. At the halfway whistle all four wing backs swap pitches, so everyone gets a bit of both. With more players, add a second 8 and a third red. With fewer, play four against one.

NUMBERS ON THE NIGHT

- Twelve or fewer: 4 v 1 plus keeper, the 8 plays as a striker as well.
- Fourteen: 5 v 2 plus keeper as drawn.
- Sixteen: add a second 8 and a third red, so 6 v 3 plus keeper.
- Odd number: the spare is a red, so it goes 5 v 3, or a second server next to the coach.
- No keeper on this pitch: use two mini goals on the goal line and finish low.

48 to 58 min: Unit v unit game, one keeper

Tim and Deano | 50m x 44m, big goal one end, two mini goals the other | 7 v 7 with one keeper, adapt on the night



SET UP

- 50m long, 44m wide. Big goal with our only keeper at one end, two mini goals at the other.
- Back unit: keeper, back three, Calum and two wing backs. They defend the big goal and score in the mini goals.
- Attack unit in bibs: two strikers, three mids and two wing backs. They attack the big goal.
- Two halves of five minutes. Restart from the attack unit at the top.

COACHING POINTS

- Back unit: ball side goes, middle covers, far side tucks, Calum screens. Win it and play out.
- Attack unit: wide and early, three runners, one shows and one spins.
- Lose it: nearest two press for five seconds.

HARDER AND EASIER

- Harder: attack unit two touch, or the back unit must make three passes before a mini goal.
- Easier: free touches, or the back unit can also score by dribbling over the top line.

HOW IT RUNS, STEP BY STEP

1. **Unit v unit, one keeper.** The game brings both practices together. The back unit is our keeper, the back three, Calum and two wing backs. They defend the big goal and score in either mini goal. The attack unit in bibs is two strikers, three mids and two wing backs, and they attack the big goal. Seven against seven with our one keeper.
2. **Attack unit goes.** The attack unit go wide early to their wing back. The back unit do what they learned with Tim. Our wing back goes to the ball, the right centre back covers, the middle and left centre backs tuck in and Calum screens. The cross comes in and the middle centre back cuts it out.
3. **Win it and play out.** Win it and go. Across to the left centre back, out to the left wing back, he drives and scores in the mini goal. That's the play out from Tim's practice in a real game. The attack unit have five seconds to win it back before it gets out.
4. **Scoring and the five second press.** Scoring. A goal in the big goal is one point, or two if the attack unit win it back and score inside ten seconds. A mini goal is one point for the back unit. Here the 10 presses the pass out, wins it, and the striker finishes. Swap the jobs at half time if you want both units to do both.
5. **Odd numbers: the floater.** Numbers on the night. Fourteen is seven against seven as drawn. Thirteen or fifteen, add a floater in a yellow bib who plays for whoever has the ball. Sixteen, add an 8 to the back unit and a third striker to the attack. Twelve, drop a centre back and the 6. No keeper, shrink the big goal to two cones.

NUMBERS ON THE NIGHT

- Twelve (6 v 6): back unit drops a centre back to a back two, attack unit drops the 6.
- Thirteen: 6 v 6 plus a floater in a yellow bib who plays for whoever has the ball.
- Fourteen (7 v 7): as drawn.
- Fifteen: 7 v 7 plus the floater.
- Sixteen (8 v 8): back unit adds an 8 next to Calum, attack unit adds a third striker or a 10.
- Ten or eleven: 5 v 5, no wing backs on the back unit, mini goals 30 metres out.
- No keeper: shrink the big goal to two cones three metres apart, goals must be below knee height.
- Coach can play as a floater too if numbers are tight.

58 to 60 min: Cool down and three questions

Tim and Deano | Centre circle | Everyone



SET UP

- Light jog, then stretch with the stretching card.
- Three questions, one line each from Tim and Deano for Reflect in Touchline later.

COACHING POINTS

- When we win it at the back, where does the first pass go?
- Wing backs: when do you drive and when do you tuck in?
- Who are the three runners in the box?

HOW IT RUNS, STEP BY STEP

1. **Jog and stretch.** Cool down. A light jog, nice and easy, then stretch with the stretching card. Get your breath back.
2. **Three questions.** Three questions. When we win it at the back, where does the first pass go? Wing backs, when do you drive and when do you tuck in? And who are the three runners in the box? Well done tonight lads.